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Virginia Board of Education, Lab Schools Standing Committee, Monday, November 6, 2023

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2CnHbFVO2mk
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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[00:07:22] standing committee and welcome to the November meeting of the standing committee. I call us to order. I will note that I have approved the remote participation of Mr. Andy Rotham and Mr. Bill Hanson under the board's bylaws under section 2.2.3708.3.3 of Dakota, Virginia. Such participation is allowed because their principal residence is more than 60 miles from the meeting location identified in the notice mr chapman would you call the role of member role for the standing

[00:07:55] committee members thank you miss wadisca mr bailey here miss wadisca present dr moran present mr hanson here and mr rotherham thank you mr chapman we will begin with a moment of silence followed by

[00:08:19] the pledge of allegiance please join me in the pledge of allegiance allegiance to the flag of

[00:09:00] the united states of america into the republic for which it stands one nation under god indivisible with liberty and justice for all all right members of the standing committee you were provided an agenda in advance of this meeting i'd like to note that i will request a motion to add another meeting uh for december 1st at the top of the action items and discussion items is there a motion to approve the amended agenda as presented to the standing committee is there a second second

[00:09:34] all those in favor of approving the amended agenda please signify by saying aye aye chair votes aye as well and the agenda is approved at this time um is there we'll move to approval of the minutes is there a motion to approve the october minutes as presented to the standing committee so moved is there a second second all those in favor of approving the october uh minutes please signify by saying aye aye chair votes aye as well and the minutes are approved at this time we'll move to public comment on agenda items the standing committee accepts public comment on all matters

[00:10:12] related to the college partnership laboratory schools in virginia public comment is an incredibly important part and a valued input for the standing committee's consideration at this time mr chapman i don't believe we have any members of the public that are here to address the committee but i did want to double check with you thank you mr chapman moving on to action items discussion items uh the first item of business is noted when we adopted the agenda the state board of education has added a meeting in december and therefore i'm proposing that the lab committee will also add a corresponding

[00:10:48] date to consider any lab school applications this would allow for the continued advisement to the state board of education this would also serve as our official last meeting of the year so therefore is there a motion to approve adding december 1st as an additional meeting for the lab committee is there a second second thank you okay all those in favor of approving the december for adding the

[00:11:20] december first meeting please signify by saying aye aye aye chair votes aye as well and the motion is approved and at this time with all of those business items dispensed with it is really my pleasure to move to item a on our agenda which is a presentation from dr jill serrata with the fanny edel bulk laboratory school good morning and welcome and thank you for being here with us this morning thank you i feel honored to be able to speak to this group about my experiences and and

[00:11:58] hopefully be able to answer any questions that you have with regard to how we're structured and set up here so that it might be helpful as you think through this process um i do have a presentation prepared that i can go through um but at any time i really want to be responsive to the needs of this group so if at any time you have questions or something that you need me to spend more time on or focus on please feel free to interrupt and we can just kind of let it flow from there so does that sound good to everyone that's excellent dr serata thank you very good let me go to

[00:12:36] the presentation and um i'm not as familiar with teams as i am with uh um zoom so okay i think you're all seeing the painting of the school correct yes yes okay thank you so much all right so um my name is is jill serata and i am um in my 29th year here at the folk laboratory school and i've been here um actually started here as a student intern in the early 90s was hired as a

[00:13:11] teacher and taught in kindergarten for many years and then moved into administration and i've served as director of admissions and now um i'm in my third year as director of the laboratory school So I know the school really, really well understand its function, understand its purpose, and see it from many perspectives, and so I'm happy to share a little bit more about the laboratory school with you, and I'll try to be quick so we have time for discussion.

[00:13:36] So the aim really after talking with Andy a week or so ago, the aim for this presentation is really to cover sort of the history and structure of bulk lab scroll briefly just to give you a sense of what the school is all about. and then really dive into the organization of the resources that we have.

[00:13:54] So how do we think about people, time, space, and money, and organize those things in favor of the school? So this is a big picture of our school. We started in the 1930s by the Falk family as a very small school.

[00:14:14] It was the the more triangular shaped building on the right side of the image that you see. in 2009, we opened everything from the glass structure in the middle to the left side that shows like three floors of classrooms. So we've expanded over time. We currently have 430 students in grades kindergarten through eight. We are a tuition-based school, so parents do pay us tuition as they would for other independent schools in the city of Pittsburgh.

[00:14:41] But we're on the campus of the University of Pittsburgh, and you can see the tall structure in the far background on the right is actually the cathedral of learning which is an iconic building for the university of pittsburgh um so we're right on the campus and um when the folk family established us in the 30s three of the words that they used in our charter agreement that i'll show you next are the words progressive experimental and demonstration and so those really set forward our mission and our purpose for existence and why we're part of the university of pittsburgh so the school was born with a charter agreement and this is not true for all laboratory schools

[00:15:17] but it was true for us that we were started in the 30s and you'll see here in the second paragraph where it talks about the family the folk family wanting students at the university to follow a teaching vocation to have a chance to observe methods of teaching in an elementary school that was controlled by the university and that the university of pittsburgh wanted to establish and maintain a progressive experimental and demonstration elementary school so those words in our original charter really set forth what we are and what we do now i didn't say that i've also i think this group spoke with nicholas ramos not too long ago the executive director of the

[00:15:56] international lab school association and i work with him regularly and i've served as president of that association um three times and uh work closely with lab schools all around the world And so if you look at the International Association of Laboratory Schools website, you'll see the functions of a laboratory school spelled out.

[00:16:16] And those are these five things that are in the middle of this Fenn diagram, educational experimentation, curriculum development, research, teacher training, and professional development. Falk in our charter had the words experimental, progressive, and demonstration. And so what I've done here is kind of shown how those three words from our charter align with all of the things that are stated as the purpose of lab schools from the International Association.

[00:16:42] Educational experimentation and curriculum development really kind of live in the experimental and progressive circles. Research is at the heart of everything that we do. All three areas, the demonstration side, the experimental and the progressive part of Falk.

[00:16:58] And then teacher training and professional development really kind of lived down more towards demonstration in what we do. So those three words just so crucially align with the purpose of us as a lab school, similar to the way John Dewey established his lab school at the University of Chicago in the late 1800s.

[00:17:19] One of the questions I get asked regularly is what makes us unique? How are we different from other independent schools in the city of Pittsburgh? And the thing that makes us unique is that lab school

function. The lab school components that I just spoke to you about really invite us to be innovative, reflective, and study the things that are happening here in the school.

[00:17:42] And that informs the way that we address the whole child. We do it in a progressive way, which means we're using authentic and meaningful learning experiences. And as we continue to address the whole child, that informs what the research is and the innovations that we have.

[00:18:00] And so one just kind of feeds into another. And we're always learning from the research and the experimentation and innovation to continue to develop our ability to address the whole child. And it just becomes cyclical. And so that's really what sets us up. Whereas other schools might focus on the child, they don't have that piece of demonstration, reflection, innovation, and study that we have here at Falk.

[00:18:24] And so that makes us different. Some of the ways that you'll see research and innovation play out in regards to the ways that we're structured here or the way we live our daily experiences is that we have a program called the Teacher Research Fellows.

[00:18:42] that invites teachers to actually be um scholarly practitioners and question their practice and learn from one another but then we also um experiment with innovative curricula so we've implemented some new new classes and programs here at bulk including a yoga and mindfulness class for the students and a class we call wonder lab for the students that um really are the result of that constant study and that search for you know what are we doing what's what could we be doing and how do we want to engage with kids so this is hard to see but i'm going to explain it

[00:19:18] as quickly as possible research at alc consists of four different tiers the top tier is research that is done by folk faculty okay the second tier is research that is done by folk faculty in collaboration with an external researcher whether that's someone from the university of pittsburgh or someone outside of the university of pittsburgh but it's in collaboration with someone else tier three is someone external to our school wants to come in and be in our school doing research in the classrooms observing teachers working with kids doing something

[00:19:54] in the building and but it's not in collaboration with us it's not authored by us and then the fourth tier is research that we share with our families that they might want to participate in that happens outside of our school on their own time and an example that might be like the audiology department once wanted to do some hearing studies of children over time and they invited children to go to their labs if they wanted where they were interested so it wasn't in collaboration with us we had nothing to do except for share that information with our families so those are the four tiers for many years we were really good at welcoming tier two three and four

[00:20:31] where we lack the resources was tier one that research done by fall faculty because they really needed supports in place to make that happen and so i'm going to dive into those supports as i get into the um explaining a little bit more about who the people are here at fall and then you'll see how we built up that tier one capacity in our school and we're getting better and better at doing that authored research ourselves so the adults in the building um here's a general organizational structure that kind of delineates the duties. Since we've grown from about 200

[00:21:06] students to 430, we've had to grow our administration and to support all of that. We now have myself here as director. I report directly to the dean of the School of Education, and then she reports to the Board of Trustees at the university. So that's the sort of the authority of the school.

[00:21:26] i oversee a leadership team of right now five people but that may change in the future i currently have a division director for k-5 so someone who oversees the program of the elementary in other words uh any family concerns for elementary age children the curriculum development and the teacher um growth and evaluation is all part of this person's job for k-5 i have another division director for middle school who does the same kind of thing as the elementary person but oversees the three middle school grades then we have a coordinator of and this is jedi because

[00:22:03] that's what she calls herself but it's justice equity diversity and inclusion and she's also the director of student services k-5 and that's something that i'm looking at changing so that's not that's still in flux right there um i have a director of administrative operations who oversees all of the staff of the building so our accountant our technology coordinator our school nurse communications coordinator information systems manager and then the secretaries and the front desk people that we have and student workers that come into the building and then i have a director of admissions who oversees an admissions coordinator and so that's how we are organized

[00:22:42] there's also on the side here a manager of constituent relations which is really sort of our development person the person who works with our alum raises funds for us is starting to grow our endowments and our capacity that way with our gifts um but she also reports to the school of education's director of development so she's kind of off to the side because she has two bosses um so recruiting and investing super important we when we recruit and and go through a hiring process we really need to ensure that we're welcoming someone who is willing to be engaged in that

[00:23:18] Annette Haworth: lab school environment, because it's more than just teaching children it's also about investigating your own practice being collaborative. Annette Haworth: and open to learning so there's a certain kind of person that we need to recruit and we try to get into that through the hiring process and the questions that we asked and then there's also the importance of investing in our faculty.

[00:23:39] Annette Haworth: i'm going to stop before I go into the research, are there any questions right now that I might be able to address. I feel like I'm speed going through this very quickly. Any questions from the committee members at this point? No, this is excellent. Please continue.

[00:23:55] Okay, I will continue. So if you remember a few minutes ago, I said that we weren't really good at that tier one, that research done by Falk faculty. That was something that was kind of a side note because we were demonstrating our teaching practices to student teachers. Every teacher here starts as a mentor to a student teacher.

[00:24:13] So there's a lot of student teachers in our building. of our teachers also teach classes for the university we welcome observers so that connection for future teachers was strong really strong and we were teaching kids and that seemed like a lot but what wasn't happening is we weren't thinking about the things that were really important to us or sticky for us um in other words there might be a moment um that a teacher is has a question in mind but never has a chance to explore that question um and so what we did was develop this

[00:24:45] research funnel for folk faculty the first level at the top of the funnel is inquiries of school culture we started to make some changes in our building where instead of setting professional goals we ask teachers just to ask questions so what is something that they want to dive deep to deep into about their professional practice and ask a question that they might explore some of the questions this year that are

really fantastic there's many really fantastic questions but one of them is from a middle school history teacher how do i teach history in a way that

[00:25:22] invites students to understand the emotional side of it to be empathetic to the events in history when they're bombarded by so many events today that they have to be numb to so his question is how is he teaching about the holocaust or how is he teaching about wars or civil rights movements and getting kids to connect to the seriousness and the pain of that time when we're so often when there's so much around them right now and so he's he's diving into that professional question um and then there are many others that i can go back to as we'll make sure we have time for discussion later so i want to dive into too many but there's some questions there

[00:26:01] so inquiries of school culture it's something that we are living into how do we solve problems together um what questions do we ask to make improvements in our school that's something that we're diving into for everyone when you have those those folks everyone asking questions about their practice some of them start to fall through this funnel just naturally organically without being pushed you know the history teacher is is like he's got this great question but now he wants to go further so he wants to look at um some other methods of teaching and working with students in

[00:26:36] that way either through other professionals or organizations or talking to the history museum just diving deeper into it and so he's falling into that level two that deeper inquiry of wanting to go further than what he than just sort of the professional growth that everyone is doing um when people start to fall through the funnel they can't help but go a little bit lower into level three and want to be a research fellow i'll explain what our research fellows do and what they they get as supports in the next few slides and then finally after becoming a research fellow it's a natural next step to present to publish um and to get back in some

[00:27:14] kind of way so that's really the funnel that we've designed that is starting to set us up into really exploring that tier one um of research and so i just went through these in a in a real in the previous slide so i'm going to skip over that if someone falls through the funnel and gets to that level three where they want to be a research fellow we ask them to come to a once a month meeting for all of our research fellows where we talk about research methodology we help them with irv processes we talk about their questions and where they can go with their questions and they

[00:27:48] kind of serves as a professional learning community for this group um and then we provide those folks with coverage one day a month so that instead of teaching they can spend time diving into their research questions they might use that to do a lit review they might use that to go to another school and observe other teachers they might use that just to sit back at our school and observe other grade levels or their own class and collect data they might already have surveys that they sent out and they need help processing that data and learning from that data and so they'll spend

[00:28:22] the day doing that um i do have oh and then they can also choose to attend a conference related to their research topic one of the things that makes this um doable for myself as an administrator is that i work with the school of education to buy out two course releases for one of their professors and so rather than paying a salary for a research coordinator who is spending their time helping people with this data and these questions i am paying about eight thousand dollars a semester to the school of education to get a course release for one of the professors who comes to fall two

[00:29:01] days a week and is here as a member of the faculty in people's classrooms talking to teachers about their questions helping get gather the data that they need to get um and so it's a rather inexpensive way for us to provide that one-on-one support this person knows the irb process knows how to publish it publish works knows apa like i couldn't do this work of asking teachers to dive into research if i didn't have that one-on-one support person and so that research coordinator role is vital for something like this and it isn't something that i can support a full salary for so this this

[00:29:37] partnership with the school event has really enabled us to do that that's investing in people that's it that's honoring their expertise their knowledge and gives them a chance to give back to the field of education which is one of the reasons they want to teach at a lab school they want to help future teachers and they want to contribute to the educational community and so these are the supports that we have in place to invest in our people something else we do to invest in our people is that we have a promotional structure for teachers usually educators or teachers have um a step salary system or it's pretty flat they're just getting the yearly

[00:30:15] increases or general increases year to year not based on any new expectations or any new asks of them as individuals and so we have this level system where if you want to jump to a new band or new level you can apply to do so let me dive into that a little bit further so level a would be for any educator that is just a recent graduate out of the school of education they're new to the profession and they want to learn um and they are learning to be teachers these are people that are between zero and five years of total teaching experience and this is sort of an

[00:30:54] up and out either you advance to the next level or you leave falk you don't stay at this level forever but it's the only band that is an up and out every other level that we present teachers can stay there as long as they like but there's an incentive to to move to the next level because there's a salary jump that they would receive going from one level to the next so level b is you're learning to be a teacher because you're always learning but then you're also committing to the profession this can be someone who's had at least three years of experience and it comes with a new set of um requirements for a teacher so at this level level b they need to engage

[00:31:34] meaningfully in the faculty growth and renewal cycle of course and they need to start mentoring student teachers um and of course they need to um oh then they need to join a faculty committee as well and some of the other things that are involved include going through an induction plan and things like that that you would have done in level a so they'll join a faculty committee of some kind and so they're really committing to the space here at bulk or the learning here at full level c you have to have three left years in level b and then you are now learning of course committing still and you're starting to take some leadership roles and

[00:32:09] leading might be being a curricular chair meeting a committee of some kind um teaching some classes leading a book club leading some professional development of some kind so there's many ways to lead in our school and if you choose to go to this level you will apply of course to move to that level and then there'll be expectations you have to meet but every level like you could You can stay at level B if you don't really want to jump into anything that involves leadership, but if you do, you'll be supported with a salary jump.

[00:32:39] And then level D, the final one, it adds the words give back. And so at that level, we're really thinking that you are teaching classes, you're publishing, you are finding ways to take all that you've

learned about education and children, capture those experiences and leave them for others to learn from.

[00:32:57] So you're not just as a 20 year veteran teaching every day. when you leave and you retire everything that you've learned walks out the door when you walk out the door we want it to be you know in the system in the fabric of education and so we ask for people to give back at that level um of course if you don't advance you still get the annual raise the jumps that come with levels would be like three thousand dollars on top of that right as you go from level to level and that will be defined as we continue to negotiate with our faculty. So that's the promotional structure. So those are the ways that we invest in the people

[00:33:33] that are working here. It's 1030. Should I wrap things up? I don't want to affect your agenda. I still have to go through a few more slides with time and money. I think we probably have like five or so more minutes for your presentation. And then what I'd love to do is open it up to questions from the lab committee. Would that work for you? That works fine for me. I have plenty of and just don't want to impact your your agenda and delay you in any way so this is fascinating i'll go quickly through time so when we think of time we think of the daily the way we use time

[00:34:09] daily and the way we use it in a yearly academic calendar daily for teachers if we want them to to do these things of mentoring other teachers and and investing in um inquiry and things like that we have to give them time to do those things our teachers have 80 minutes of common planning time so that they can work with their partner teachers their greater life teachers to design authentic learning experiences that are collaborative and engaging and they also get a 30 minute break every day so that's something that that is important for us here's an example of daily schedules i do believe you have access to these slides so you can go back and look at

[00:34:46] the daily schedules the teachers get their planning time when the students go to their humanities classes so in the kindergarten through fifth grade this sample schedule is a first and second grade room and they have their humanities from 1 30 to 2 50 and that's the teacher's planning time that 80 minutes that the teacher gets in the middle school the teachers have this morning time this 8 30 to 10 o'clock for their planning time because the kids are in their humanities specials classes visit and things like that so i'm going to jump forward there's so much more i can go into a

[00:35:21] daily schedule but keeping it quick um the teachers are on 10 month contracts and that's very important to us because they need the time before kids come at the end of august to dive into some of the professional development that we really need to do as a whole school we have plenty of time for whole school meetings there's about two weeks in august where we're able to utilize that time some of it is standard safety first aid all that kind and then there's also usually some whole school initiatives that we want to dive into this year we're diving into structured literacy we have once a month wednesday early dismissals that brings together the whole faculty for

[00:35:59] continued professional development it gives us an hour and a half an extended meeting time with faculty and as long as i've been here for 29 years we've always had weekly faculty meetings on mondays from four to five so we have plenty of whole school meeting time and then the teachers have greater life meeting time every day if we don't have that time in the schedule um we couldn't do the things that we do we really need the time to talk and to learn from one another going through space thinking about space the more people we hire the more office space i need and we don't have enough so now people are sharing offices and that's a problem so that's something i have to think about of course we need spaces for students that are wide open and allow group work and collaboration

[00:36:39] and then we need spaces that support our mission if we want authentic experiences we need spaces that take advantage of the geography and the urban campus that we have um for the students and so here's just something that they do in third grade they map the city by building um 3d structures and then using one of our outdoor spaces to make a grid and actually map the city using map skills that they're developing um we have spaces for children to work collaboratively the kinds of furniture we order and the way we set up our spaces really help kids to work collaboratively we have outdoor spaces even though we're an urban campus we've set aside some outdoor space that is

[00:37:17] specifically supposed to be for their environmental educational experiences and then also some play experiences like a mud kitchen that we have we have a wonder lab class it's one of our innovative curriculum it allows kids to use new technology with familiar older ways of of making like sewing and um woodworking and things like that so and then getting into money and then i'll stop so the money side is probably the hardest part for anyone to understand the charter says that the university must erect and maintain a school building that's it everything else comes from

[00:37:57] our budget and so they will provide external maintenance grounds janitorial services and anything to the exterior of the building anything we do interior the renovation of spaces materials that we need for class things like that all come from our own budget my budget is separate from let me see how to stop sharing there we go my budget is separate from the universities but it is managed by the university systems and it's really really strange and

[00:38:37] difficult but the tuition dollars that we raise pay salaries they pay all the fringe benefits for teachers and all the materials and the program that we do um and then every once in a while we have to pay facilities for any extra work that we have above and beyond what they are chart our charter agreement says they need to do so um questions dr ross serrata thank you so much for that let's uh see if we have questions from the lab committee members uh we'll ask uh our two remote lab committee members first dr rotherham or excuse me mr rotherham or mr hanson should you

[00:39:10] you have any questions? You're good. Okay. And then anyone? I have a quick question, Dr. Serrata. I'm really interested because, you know, our laboratory schools in Virginia are really focused through a public lens in terms of requirements, you know, meeting all of the regulations and laws and policies that are set at the state and board of education level. And I'm wondering, as a private entity, it seems like you have a lot of flexibility and freedom around time,

[00:39:48] et cetera, that would be a challenge for public entities. But I also knew in doing some research that you have had some interaction with the public education system through Remake Learning in Pittsburgh. And just wondering, how do you see the public-private potential as being able to leverage ideas and innovation into the lab school sphere, understanding that you live in a different world than our public educators do? Yeah, that's a great question, and that's one that some of our

[00:40:25] other public lab schools struggle with. If you wanted to talk to any of them, there's Burris Lab School in Indiana, and then there's Kilby Laboratory School in Alabama that I would invite you to talk their directors about that because they are tied to some of those state systems so we are not we are accredited and that's what allows us the capacity to run as an independent school that we have to go through an accreditation process but we're still looking toward the public school system to help inform what we do there's so much to learn from them and so much for them to learn

[00:41:01] from us and so the some of the questions or some of the places that we can get um really i think concerned is when you're facing testing um or certain curricular things there can be a you know we need to do it this way um kind of thinking and what we've learned is that the authentic experiences are more applicable um to real learning and we know from the hierarchy of learning that when you can apply things and create you're not just memorizing you're actually diving deeper

[00:41:41] into learning and the kids our kids do really well on a lot of the the public school testing that they have to take as they go on to high school so they leave us in ninth grade and continue on and they do really well um but you raise a good question how are you it's sort of the feeling trapped or like you don't have the flexibility with schedule when you are trying to cover certain things. I think it takes someone who is able to look at that standard curriculum like we are with

[00:42:20] structured literacy and say, where do we have the ability to question how things are being done and where do we need to follow the program as it is? What's important to maintain and why?

[00:42:36] And then what kind of decisions can we make and why? And that's something that we're doing with structured literacy as we implement that um thinking through like we can't have teachers just autonomously leaving out whole sections of of learning like repeating um phonemic sounds because a teacher feels like it's just echoing and they don't see the learning so if they make a decision like that to leave off a piece of a curriculum sort of an outline of a curriculum uh that's where our research coordinator would go in and say can you tell me about the decision or

[00:43:13] one of our division directors can you tell me about the decision to leave that off why are you doing that not just go in and say you're wrong you have to do this but to say why are you doing that and the teacher will say um i just feel like my students who know it really well are really bored in that moment and then someone you know the division director or the research coordinator would say to them okay let me explain to you a little bit about the purpose of that and why it's important and then help you make a decision that will use what you're learning because of the students in front of you and this desire to keep people engaged but also not lose the importance of that importance of that learning experience so you kind of have to dive deeper than just doing

[00:43:53] and really think about what's being asked and how you're doing it i don't know if that helps at all i hope so dr sarah thank you so much i think one of our i'm just going to pause for a moment i believe mr hansen got dropped from the meeting is trying to get back in okay thank you my apologies um dr sarah that is excellent i really appreciate the information that you've provided us um you've given it it's clear first thank you for your leadership within the international association of lab schools it's clear you are an expert on international you know on lab schools and i can see why you've been such an asset not only to other lab schools but you've been an asset

[00:44:31] to us here in virginia today and i want to really appreciate thank you for giving us frameworks to again you uniquely define the characteristics of lab schools and then a framework to think about the research funnel and your language also uh i really appreciated was how to support the adults in the building and how to think about really giving the adults who are engaging in the practice of education uh support time uh joint planning that that was very helpful so so thank you so much for that information and also thank you for the referral for two other lab schools that you

[00:45:10] might recommend that we might uh make an inquiry of and staff have noted that and we'll be chatting with them further and so we appreciate that referral i'd love to chat with you further um we do

have to continue with our agenda today but i trust that you will be at our disposal should we have any follow-up questions i would be happy to answer any more questions and go a little deeper into any one of those areas that that would be helpful for your group thank you so much for the the opportunity to speak with all of you and thank you for sharing your time and expertise with us today thank you thank you bye bye thank you all right at this time that was excellent thank you staff for making those arrangements as well uh at this time we're going to move to item b which

[00:45:50] is final review of the college partnership lab school application from for germana community college uh dr armstrong will be speaking to this item thank you madam chair and committee members before i begin i did want to make sure that we have everyone online and that is miss landry from germana as well as i believe it's dr bayard who is also here representing jmu as part of that partnership members of the committee and miss budeska i'm pleased to provide you with this overview of the now once reviewed germana community college future educators academy

[00:46:27] lab school proposal which is a partnership among germana community college laurel ridge community College, James Madison University, and the superintendent's region four school divisions of Culpeper, Madison, Clark, Fauquier, Frederick, Page, Rappahannock, Shenandoah, Warren, and Winchester City. The goal of FEA to provide high-quality accelerated teacher education to produce exceptional teachers is responsive to the continuing shortage of qualified professional teachers in Central Virginia. Students enrolled in the FEA lab school will experience hands-on

[00:47:02] an exposure to the profession and participate in a streamlined, scalable model designed to accelerate the path to full teacher licensure, including dual enrollment coursework toward an associate's degree that will include several required courses and experiences needed to achieve full licensure as a Virginia teacher, allowing students of FEA to potentially be graduates and applicants to local school divisions in their openings within two years of graduating from the lab school. The VDOE received the FAA application on August 10, 2023, and in the intervening three months, the agency has collaborated with the applicant as follows.

[00:47:41] During the week of August 21, 2023, the VDOE subject matter expert team provided detailed feedback in each compliance-related section of their application. The goal of the Application Review Technical Expert Committee is to document the needed technical expertise and provide counseling to the applicants to identify and correct any potential deficiencies in the planning and implementation of the proposed college partnership laboratory school, determine compliance with state law regulation, highlight potential problems or red flags with information contained in the Germanna application, and to identify aspects of the proposal that are especially

[00:48:17] exciting or unique. The subject matter team included and still includes myself, Mr. Rob Gilstrap from the Office of Licensure and School Leadership, Ms. Amy Siepka from the Office of Accountability, Ms. Rebecca Askew from the Office of Policy, Mr. Ed Lanza from the Office of Budgeting, Ms. Melissa Velasquez from the Department of Policy and Communications, Dr. Samantha Hollins from the Department of Special Education and Student Services, and Dr. Dave Myers, our Deputy Superintendent in the Office of Data, Research, and Technology. Each VDOE subject matter expert was provided with the Laboratory School Criteria Checklist Worksheet, which is included in your

[00:48:55] agenda. Areas of expertise were assigned to various staff subject to their education expertise here at VDOE. The compilation of these comments is included in the spreadsheet that is attached. The

Completance and Compliance Report corresponds to the lab school application and reflects the following dimensions of compliance. An executive summary, mission and vision, educational program, governance, management structure, financial and operations, placement planned, and additional assurances the applicant in this case germana was responsive to the subject matter expert

[00:49:31] feedback and the questions that we provided and did provide their edits of the application and addendums as required to meet compliance items of required attention by the applicant included a revised budget to meet the per people funding limit clarification of compliance with human resources and student records requirements additional detail related to testing and accountability and expansion of language related to sustainability the applicant responded with their edited application and addenda on september 12 2023 which was subsequently reviewed by the subject matter expert teams on september 15 2023 once it was established that the applicant had

[00:50:10] provided satisfactory responses to the vdoe the fea application was placed on the agenda for first Standing Committee review on October 3rd, 2023. The FEA presented to the Standing Committee on October 3rd, responded to questions of the committee, and was approved by the Standing Committee on October 3rd to proceed to today's second Standing Committee review. The FEA application was posted for public comment following the October 3rd Standing Committee meeting on October 12th and remained available until October 27th, and no comment was received. On behalf of the For the Virginia Department of Education, I submit that the Germanna Community College

[00:50:47] Future Educators Academy Lab School is compliant and ready for implementation, and I recommend to the committee that the Future Educators Academy be approved on second review to be forwarded to the Virginia Board of Education for their consideration for approval at their November 15, 2023 meeting.

[00:51:04] And I do have our representatives here on hand to answer any questions of the committee today. Thank you, Dr. Armstrong. And please, on our behalf, thank the members of the committee for their time and service in reviewing this application. Yes. Are there any further questions on the Germana Community College application for members of the Lab Committee?

[00:51:23] Absolutely. Hearing none, at this time, is there a motion to approve the Germana Community College application on second review and refer the Germana Community College Lab School application to the Virginia State Board of Education for approval? So moved.

[00:51:39] Second. all those in favor of the motion please signify by saying aye all right the chair votes i as well and note for the record that mr hansen and mr rotherham vote aye as well and the motion is approved congratulations to germana community college we look forward to the consideration of your application before the virginia state board of education later this month at this time we will move to um on behalf of the committee but before i proceed i direct the staff to finalize a a report with the Standing Committee's comments that were made at the prior meeting and to

[00:52:17] compile the report along with this application and all additional material received by the Standing Committee and to bundle this information and refer it to the State Board of Education for consideration at the November meeting. Thank you again for your deliberation on this application. At this time, we'll move to item C. Final review of the College Partnership Laboratory School application from the University of Mary, Washington. Mr. Armstrong, can you have the floor. Please continue. Thank you,

Madam Chair, committee members. I'd like to first welcome Dr. Michael Bolling of Stafford County Public Schools and Mr. Peter Kelly, who I believe is

[00:52:52] also here on behalf of the University of Mary Washington, and they are here to answer any questions of the committee. As I go through our review, Dr. Towery, who was here with us, is out of the country currently, but wishes she could be here, and we will share the news upon the conclusion of today's meeting. Members of the committee and chair with this guy, I'm pleased to provide you with this overview of the now-once-reviewed University of Mary Washington Academy of Technology and Innovation Lab School Proposal, a collaboration among the University of Mary Washington and Stafford County Public Schools as the fiscal agent and

[00:53:28] hiring agent, as well as four other school divisions in Superintendents Region 3, which include Caroline County, Fredericksburg City, King George County, and Spotsylvania County. The goal of ATI is to combine an emphasis on computer and data science fields with innovative interdisciplinary teaching practices and learning experiences for high school students, and is responsive to the continuing demand for skilled graduates prepared to enter the computer and data science industry, additionally a local market demand in the region affected by ATI.

[00:53:59] The student experience at ATI will be characterized by project-based authentic learning approaches where field experiences will be leveraged whenever possible to ensure students engage in authentic learning and real-world problem solving. This approach will ensure students are able to witness and experience the application of computer science, data science, and broader technology across content areas and economic industries through work-based learning experiences.

[00:54:24] As part of this approach, intentionality will be given towards the provision of externships and internships to build the durable skills necessary to enter the workforce. UMW will leverage all three of its colleges to support the efforts of the Lab School, providing content experts from the College of Arts and Sciences and the College of Business to consult on the development of curricular resources and field experiences in partnership with the College of Education and Stafford County Public Schools.

[00:54:50] The VDOE received the ATI application on August 7th, 2023, and in the intervening three months, the agency has collaborated with the applicant as follows. During the week of August 21st, 2023, the VDOE subject matter expert team provided detailed feedback in each compliance-related section of the application.

[00:55:10] If it pleases the committee, I will move through the description of that subject matter team since we took care of that in our last review. Thank you, Dr. Armstrong. Thank you. The applicant was responsive to subject matter expert feedback and questions and provided edits to their application and addendums as required to meet compliance.

[00:55:29] Items that required attention by the applicant included clarification on the targeted student population, attachment of links that detailed the instructional and curriculum model, schedule, governance structure, and parental involvement plan of ATI, a code of conduct, and additional detail on financials and clarification related to the proposed facility.

[00:55:49] An on-site visit was scheduled to provide technical assistance in preparation for final application submission, responsive to subject matter expert feedback, and to better assess the true facility

needs of ATI. This visit took place at the UMW Stafford campus on Tuesday, September 19, 2023, with Ms. Wadiska, myself, and Dr. Towery of UMW and ATI.

[00:56:11] The applicant responded to on-site recommendations and VDOE subject matter expert feedback with their edited application and addenda on September 25, 2023, which was subsequently reviewed by the subject matter expert team immediately. Once it was established that the applicant had provided satisfactory responses to the VDOE, the ATI application was placed on the agenda for first standing committee review on October 3, 2023. ATI presented to the standing committee on October 3, responded to questions of the committee, and was approved by the standing committee on October 3rd to proceed to today's second standing committee review. The ATI application was posted for public

[00:56:50] comment following the October 3rd standing committee meeting on October 12th, which remained available until October 27th, and no comment was received. On behalf of the Virginia Department of Education, I submit that the University of Mary Washington Academy of Technology and Innovation Lab School is compliant and ready to implement, and I recommend to the committee that the Academy of Technology and Innovation be approved on second review to be forwarded to the Virginia Board of education for their consideration for approval at their november 15 2023 meeting thank you dr armstrong again please thank the members of the committee for their tremendous work on this application

[00:57:26] and certainly thank university of mayor washington for the submittal and modifications made there into their application are there any questions at this time on members of the lab committee hearing none is there a motion to approve the university of mary washington's application for a college lab school on second review and we prefer the matter to the virginia state board of education for approval so moved is there a second second all those in favor of approving the motion please signify by saying aye aye let the record note that mr hansen mr rotherham also virtually vote aye

[00:58:03] the chair votes i as well and the motion carries the virginia university of mary washington's apology lab school application is approved and on behalf of the committee it's my pleasure to direct the staff at videoe to finalize a report with the standing committee's comments to compile that report along with the application and all additional material received by the standing committee as well as the university of mary washington to refer and recommend that the university of mary washington's application be presented to the virginia state board of education at the november meeting with the notation of recommendation for approval thank you and

[00:58:40] congratulations to the university of mary washington thank you gentlemen for being here virtually with us today at this time we thank you we look forward to visiting your schools at this time we move on to item d all right item d is first review of a college partnership lab school application from george mason university and today we have a number of experts and representatives here from george mason university who have joined us to discuss

[00:59:16] their lab school application. Good morning. Good morning. It's a pleasure to be here with you on behalf of our partners, George Mason University, Novo Community College, and Fairfax County Public Schools. I'd like to present now our vision. The vision of this lab school is to prepare adaptable lifelong learners. Would you like to introduce your entire team? Do you have your

[00:59:39] Angela, as yourself, I know there's a number of representatives that came all the way from George Mason, as well as Nova, and if they'd like to come up to the microphone, introduce themselves, my

apologies if I'm putting you on the spot, but you made the drive, and you're here, and we'd love to have an opportunity for you to say hello to the committee members.

[00:59:57] Introduce yourself, and if you could briefly describe your role with the lab school, that would be helpful. Thank you. Hello, my name is Kristen Carter. I'm Associate Director of Dual Enrollment at Northern Virginia Community College. Good morning. Kami Singura, Executive Director, Institute for Digital Innovation, also Professor in Information Sciences and Technology Department at George Mason University. I'm also a Co-PI on this grant.

[01:00:27] Hi. Hi, my name is Kimberly Daly. I'm working as a Project Manager for Access Academy at Mason. Thank you. Now I can't remember if I introduced myself, but I guess I will. I am excellent. I'm the Dean of the College of Education and Human Development at George Mason University, and I've been thrilled to lead this team of really committed colleagues who who want to just create something very innovative for our students.

[01:00:54] so as as indicated here in our vision oh and one last thing our fairfax county public schools partners send their regrets it's the end of the quarter and uh professional development day for our teachers so it was just really difficult for them to make the drive um so our mission for access academy is to prepare adaptable lifelong learners that collaboratively and creatively solve complex problems in any settings and this it's really important because we know that technologies the nature of work workers and the workplace are just going to continue to evolve

[01:01:30] so we want to make sure that our students have those uh that adaptability that is the product of of our uh offering and so to do that we envision providing a new innovative set of pathways for traditionally underserved students toward high demand well compensated careers and at the same time working to that two and four-year degree to maximize their earning potential over their entire work lives. So there's four innovative areas of innovation that are integrated into

[01:02:06] this lab school. First, what we intend to do is provide a problem-based learning IT curriculum design, and it's designed from that problem-based learning approach with additional layers of complexity from their junior year towards their senior year. And it really is something that translates to the work environment as our students are called upon to partner with others to solve complex problems. The other innovative element is the idea of employability skills. Some may refer to it as 21st century skills. These are really important to employers and things like systems

[01:02:43] thinking, critical thinking, collaboration across a variety of different stakeholders and partners employers being flexible, having excellent communication skills, but things that employers are really looking for, not just today and not just for one career pathway, but really across really all career trajectory.

[01:03:02] So we want to make sure that there's an emphasis in this area of skill sets in addition to content matter areas. Also, this competency based approach, it's really important that students are able to demonstrate the skills that employers are looking for.

[01:03:19] So the employability skills create certainly one set of competencies, but also specific competencies in IT are going to be the focus of the learning objectives, but also performance-based assessments.

[01:03:34] And finally, the learn and earn model, which creates an opportunity for students to develop real on-the-job experience through paid internships at their senior year with our industry partners. It just

provides one additional level of practice and career readiness when they leave school.

[01:03:55] The Learning Innovation Lab Fuse at Mason Square is one of our contexts. It's going to be the setting for an immersive experience where students will have the opportunity to carry out their on-the-job paid internships, which embodies a learn and earn model.

[01:04:11] But also, they're going to be working hand in hand with researchers from Mason, which are, of course, engaging in partnerships with industry partners, really at the cutting edge of solving the most pressing societal problems.

[01:04:29] So students will be in this environment, both with industry partners and also researchers. In addition, this setting is going to serve as a learning innovation lab where teacher candidates and service teachers and IT faculty can continue to develop their problem-based learning skills and other innovative instructional pedagogies.

[01:04:55] Active learning and development is also something that can be observed through the state-of-the-art environment where we have significant setups to really look at the behavior and the science of learning. And so it's really set up for a variety of different on-site observations and field experiences. The transdisciplinary collaborations is also something really important. We know, of course, that to solve the world's most pressing problems, we can't really just employ one perspective or one discipline or one partner. We really have to work across partners such as

[01:05:31] industry, academia, government, and others. We also are very proud of our collaboration with the School of Computing and IT. So it's gonna be both educational experts and also information technology experts and researchers and faculty working together.

[01:05:54] And of course, part of that broad learning ecosystem is consistent on the relationships and partnerships, already established partnerships, with Nova Community College and Fairfax County Public Schools, which really provides the environment for the dual enrollment, as well as other wraparound services, such as tutoring, library resources, writing laboratories, and many others.

[01:06:24] So in this very detailed graph, Hopefully, everybody can kind of see the specific elements we really have to consistent on ramps, which is the junior and senior year at the high school level. But what we'd like to do, and although we're starting in the first year with the junior and senior Rams, starting in year two, we do foresee then scaling the interventions all the way to ninth grade by providing our

[01:06:55] teachers with professional development opportunities and problem based learning, ensuring that there's the integration of those competencies in the skill sets that we've talked about earlier in terms of employability skills and such, and as much as possible, we'd like to align to other STEM programs in the school divisions.

[01:07:18] As we get into the sophomore year, we're also adding the school visits from our industry partners, presentations that really raise awareness about a variety of high-paying careers that really get the students excited about these.

[01:07:35] As we look into the junior year, we'll also start providing the direct experiential problem-based learning IT curriculum. Dual enrollment then kicks in here in this junior year, of course, across all the years with ongoing teacher professional development.

[01:07:54] We're also planning to incorporate peer mentoring, and we have a variety of different structures already to do that, including our Early Identification Program, which really helps students at risk and traditionally underrepresented to just expose them to all kinds of opportunities as far as college options.

[01:08:17] Here in this junior year, again, we also will be providing the Immersive Views Research and Innovation Campus Experience, which we described just a bit ago. And at the junior year, they do begin to develop that on-the-job experience working with employers and other partners through an unpaid internship.

[01:08:37] Senior year offers another on-ramp. And again, providing those same kind of benefits in addition to a more intensive employability skills development, we felt strongly that in some cases, some students may not really be thinking of those after high school options until their senior year.

[01:08:57] So we wanted to make sure that we could provide something for them. In this case, it'll be a more intensive experience with employability skills development, as well as working hand-in-hand with our Mason students through a peer mentoring model. And again, here we would be offering the on-the-job paid internship to really develop that interest in the experience in an environment that is aligned also to completing their university career that there is that kind of you know bi-directional benefit and as you have here really thinking very

[01:09:36] structurally about our outcomes and scaffolding them from short-term to mid-term to long-term this is really important for us because as you will see later when i discuss the sustainability plan it's really important to be very clear on what we're trying to accomplish so that we can and monitor progress along the way.

[01:09:56] We know that the teacher component is quite important. So we wanna make sure that our teachers are supported in developing competence in problem-based learning and that the students are developing their foundational skills in problem-based learning and employability skills.

[01:10:13] And that they're also receiving the wide range of administrative and financial supports to make sure that they're able to access of higher education, meaning long term we're progressing through 11th and 12th graders earning anywhere between 15 to 30 dual enrollment credits, which is a significant time saving and budget saving as well.

[01:10:41] as we progress on to the long term we're really looking to ensure that students have an opportunity to earn two and four year degrees that employers find these graduates well prepared and are excited to continue to recruit new ones and that access graduates really are prepared and positioned to increase their earning potential throughout a lifetime which we know with a two and four year degree is still really critical so our governance uh structure similar to some of the things that

[01:11:15] we've heard just a bit ago the idea would be for uh myself representing uh george mason university would report directly to the virginia department of education along with my colleagues at noble community college and fcps which our counterparts would be the chief academic officers the director of the lab school will report directly to me and the team would include academic and career coach for the lab academy professional development coordinator the advisor and recruiter and of

[01:11:50] course the wide range of faculty and staff from george mason university who will also be supporting the project the lab school excuse me initially in our launch we have identified wonderful

accommodations and spaces at annandale high school and we plan to start with the 11th and 12th grade in the initial year and thereafter begin to expand our work to 9th and 10th grade uh professional development of teachers and such such as the other things that we mentioned earlier

[01:12:29] um we will always this is something important to to highlight which i mentioned just a bit ago we'll always offer a junior and senior on-ramp for students even if they did not begin with the ninth and tenth grade uh foundational problem-based learning and just here uh we also have our nova Community College Annandale campus which is nearby making it easier to access those college courses

[01:13:02] as well and on the financial just to highlight over the five-year grant the costs are estimated to be at 6.8 million dollars approximately of which the funding requested is six million seventy three thousand and george mason uh is prepared to cost share in the amount of seven hundred and forty one thousand at this point we of course will continue to do quite a bit of fundraising and um you know really sharing this opportunity with uh potential donors who i think would also be excited

[01:13:41] for uh this innovative approach to educating our students uh after the initial pilot year uh and any improvements i want to highlight that we are considering this a pilot year because we've designed something that we think will work well and we need to collect data data collection ongoing evaluation and monitoring is going to be really critical to make sure we understand what is working for whom and under what conditions and what needs to be tweaked before we can really

[01:14:15] engage in a scaling up plan and so here as i mentioned before in terms of the sustainability certainly our engagement among the partners is really really critical because we're leveraging our assets and our expertise here so mason fairfax county public schools nova and our industry partners the engagement through a number of activities if you look at the design that we've engaged really it requires everyone to pitch in and collaborate uh ongoing monitoring and evaluation as i mentioned will be really critical way to generate the input and the feedback that we need

[01:14:54] to make really good decisions um for the future of the program and our students uh continued diversified funding strategy um ongoing professional development for educators and support and recognition and incentives is just simply so important for them another piece that's really critical is fostering the community among the alumni and uh and the families because i think in addition to sharing the real impact that the lab school experience has has had on them i think that that it's also part of developing trust and credibility with with other partners and donors

[01:15:31] because the idea is to scale up eventually so that's going to be really critical i mentioned the use of data to inform strategic decisions and of course the scalable and replicable model really do depend on understanding what parts of this model are really critical you know there are so many different factors that we need to understand and study to make sure that we understand when scaling up these are the non-negotiables and here are some of the other areas that perhaps we have flexibility around and so with that i'd be happy to take additional

[01:16:06] questions just a few pictures here what we envision our fuse uh innovative lab school space to be we envision it to be a very exciting place of learning and doing and uh really having our students look forward to engaging thank you very much thank you very much for your presentation at this time i'd like to open it to questions from lab committee members mr hansen or mr rothram do you have any questions mr hanson well thank you very much for the presentation and as a george mason alumnus i

[01:16:41] was thrilled to see the proposal coming forward and thank you for the partnerships that you could develop to bring it forward um and maybe i missed it being remote but maybe if you could just help me understand a little bit more clearly the pipeline of the student population um both initially but also um as you build this out um and is it going to be geographically around the annandale area and if it's more broadly how is the transportation going to be handled for those students yes uh thank you for that question so we selected annandale in particular because it has a

[01:17:20] quite a diverse population so we thought for the pilot year would be a really good location to have access to those students who were wanting to make sure that that you know have something that works for them in terms of a pathway toward both higher education and well-compensated careers the idea would be for students to draw upon students who would have gone to annadale to begin with so in terms of transportation for that initial pilot year it would rely on what fairfax communities what fairfax schools already provides for the subsequent years we would envision drawing

[01:18:00] or really scaling up to a regional consortia and so the details of that that design has not been said at this point we do want to collect some initial data first to see what what happens from this one site approach um we do uh intend to have uh bus transportation secured from fairfax schools to make the the one day a week travel to the arlington campus uh but the majority of those activities will be at annandale so they'll still be able to access a lot of the extracurricular

[01:18:37] activities and resources that would have been set for them maybe just one quick follow-up just in terms of the six million dollar budget just trying to understand a little bit on the roi what would be the um the capacity of the student body that you would envision in the long term so initially we're uh in the year two to five we're expecting about 120 students at this point uh and again this is preliminary so i think understanding what are those critical elements that really make a

[01:19:13] difference in the learning outcomes will be really important i think in many cases in other school divisions there are some current programmings and assets that we could tap into understanding which of those are really critical will help us with the scaling up plan thank you thank you other members of the committee dr moran i i really appreciate the competency-based approach that that you're embedding in this particularly in the content areas of focus that you're going after that i'm

[01:19:49] interested in it and have been working with a high school in clark county nevada which actually is quite a bit bigger than fairfax and they have been building out similar kinds of academies all over their district to try to do exactly what you're doing i don't think that they have the partnership at the higher education level but one of the principals there said to me that his goal is that they move their kids from a focus on seat time to revenue generation that he would like to see every one of the students going through that comprehensive high school um able to generate

[01:20:24] revenue prior to graduating from high school and be able to leave with the skill sets that not are just about the content of what you might see as cte traditional pathways but also be highly educated well-educated young people and so i'm wondering if that's something that that you've talked about because i mean virginia does have a seat time waiver that allows kids to move through coursework at a much faster pace but it does require you to have to really dig in with a superintendent to figure out whether that could be relevant to the pathways that kids are going to

[01:21:04] take through the program that's of interest to me is to see some models in virginia go after that through a competency lens so i'm pleased to see this today that you've got that embedded thank Thank

you. Yeah, I think that that's certainly a possibility. I think understanding very clearly what the observable skills that we really are aiming for then gives us the flexibility on the how to accomplish that. So focus on the content solely or focus on knowledge to solely gives us one level of learning, but it doesn't necessarily give us that ability for them to demonstrate performance and competence, which employers are looking for. So yeah, I think that that's

[01:21:43] definitely a possibility. Well, and also tying to, you know, similarly to the academies of Hampton that they've really laid out very clearly in Hampton. These are the certifications, the licenses, the variety of different ways that kids can through some external evaluations demonstrate those competencies. So I would hope that that would be something that you could fold in as well.

[01:22:07] Yeah, absolutely. Certifications that are available now or credentialing that's available either through our partners or others that we might be able to create. In fact, also in alignment with what teachers may also be able to generate as, I would say, demonstrations of advanced professional development and skill sets is something that we're looking at as well.

[01:22:30] That's just, thank you. Thank you. Go ahead. Maybe just one question. I loved both in your application and on your presentation, it was sort of the stacked bar graphs by grade. Yes. Which was incredibly exciting, but you could tell that there are a lot of different sort of micro options for students kind of within there. Can you talk a little bit about how, kind of what is those wraparound supports that you help them with making decisions as to whether or not they do a learn to earn or whether they pursue dual enrollment? Just how do they help make sense of all the different sort of myriad of pathways you're presenting them?

[01:23:06] Yeah, so we do have a career coach that's going to be really instrumental. So a couple of things. I had mentioned the early identification program, which is a program that's already fully launched and structured. So we're leveraging as much as possible resources that already exist.

[01:23:22] But that is an introduction to students about what is available, what different pathways such as the Access Academy might be available to them. And really the junior, every option that you see here, rather than being optional, is really the full treatment for that grade level.

[01:23:44] And so we would be expecting all of the students, for example, in that junior year to be concluding that junior year with an unpaid internship, for example. We would be providing access to the writing center, to mentorship, to really all of the things that we've listed here, just to make sure that they have that additional wraparound support to make that progress throughout that academic and really work experience as smooth as possible.

[01:24:14] Yeah, thank you. Mr. Rotherham? Thank you, Mrs. Scott. This is great. I'm excited about this. I'm excited to see you in Florida. I have a question that essentially builds on and goes almost the inverse of Mr. Hanson's.

[01:24:32] I get how you're attracting students and what that's going to look like in the growth. Can you just talk a little bit about what supports can be available for students and their families who choose this path and then decide this actually isn't the right one? What supports can be available to help them reintegrate into their old school or make a different choice?

[01:24:50] Yeah. So one of the things about the model is it isn't so much a different pathways as much as it provides additional layers of support. And so if students decide that this is not for them, they're still going

to be working toward their graduation requirements for high school.

[01:25:08] And so they would just continue on to that. They can choose different electives that they would have chosen had they not been using their elective towards dual enrollment courses. Excellent. Well, first, I want to say thank you for a very well-written, coherent, thoughtfully organized application. It is quite clear when you read the application, the amount of effort

[01:25:37] and thought that has been put into your plan, as well as the considerable time that has been invested in thinking how that plan will be executed at a high quality, in a high quality way.

[01:25:55] So I want to first thank you for that. It's, you know, it's, I know these applications are very difficult to write, and the questions are a bit clunky. And so when we see an applicant that, despite the clunkiness, provide eloquence and coherence, it is really appreciated. So thank you first for that. So I know there was probably a team, and please give our gratitude to the team.

[01:26:19] I too, like Mr. Bailey, really appreciated the vignette to help show what a day in the life might look like or a year in the life of a student so that we can see what that student experience would look like.

[01:26:35] And it's really exciting to see the multiple pathways that students would have ramps into the program, ramps out of the program, a coherence between, just as Dr. Moran was noting, an application of a gaining of skills, a demonstration of skills, and then a link of those skills to an external credential in the marketplace that will have tangible value when they leave their high school experience.

[01:27:02] So that was really wonderful to see. And certainly, we are always excited to see applicants that showcase the importance of having training grounds for future teachers. I mean, that is an area that every applicant at this juncture needs to be giving serious consideration to. And that was fundamental to the plan that you put forward.

[01:27:24] The one question I do have is on who will be able to attend your school. In your overview, it notes at-risk students. The law is really clear. It has to be open to all students. There will be some guidance and best practices being issued from the VDOE on how to effectively run a lottery.

[01:27:45] But if you could speak for a few moments about what will be the process to apply for consideration to attend the lab school, just so that we can kind of have that on the record to further affirm that it is really open to all students.

[01:28:02] Sure. It is indeed open to all students, and we selected Annandale because it is going, given that it's such a diverse school and population, that we really would have the widest possible pool to draw from in terms of, you know, all students.

[01:28:21] We're really working with the Early Identification Program also as a main recruitment partner and really kind of doing outreach to everybody. As we know, sometimes the information doesn't really flow well to everybody, and those students end up being at risk of not taking advantage of many possibilities that they have.

[01:28:39] And so it really it really is based on as wide as possible outreach across in this first year Annandale High School to make sure everyone has access to this and that it isn't seen as just for high achieving students or just for a different kind of students, but for everybody, in fact.

[01:28:58] And so we'll be working with early identification program to make sure that we leverage some of their outreach activities already and then making sure that we're creating a very clear process thereafter

for everybody to have a chance to know about this.

[01:29:18] No, thank you for that. And your application goes into this in some detail, but I do appreciate you further expounding on it verbally. The family engagement strategies that are proposed are excellent. And thank you for the additional due diligence, just as you said, to make sure that everyone knows. Sometimes not everyone does, right? So thank you for that.

[01:29:38] all right are there any further questions or comments from members of the committee at this time seeing none um is there a motion to approve george mason university's application for first review and post the application for our 10-day public comment period your bill has changed so moved by bill as an alumnus we'll allow that is there a second a second and there's a second all those in favor please signify by saying aye Aye. Please note for the record, Mr. Hanser, Mr. Rotherham, vote aye virtually. The chair votes

[01:30:13] aye as well. The motion passes unanimously. Congratulations. Thank you very much, Madam Chair and committee. Thank you. On behalf of the committee, I direct the staff to post the George Mason University application for a 10-day public comment period in accordance with the Standing Committee's procedures, then compile any comments received by the public to review those comments and to present them to the Standing Committee for consideration upon second review at the December lab committee meeting all right that concludes our action items at this part of the agenda we're going to now move to presentations and written reports and this will begin the dr

[01:30:51] andy armstrong show for this portion of the meeting um so feel free to just keep the floor and keep going pause so that we can ask questions but the floor is yours certainly thank you madam chair committee members uh this month i'd like to provide a few brief updates and if i could There it is. Thank you. First, our update on our planning grant expenditures. And as you can see, since last month, we have fully approved the Ferrum College planning grant application.

[01:31:25] And we've also received two additional planning grant applications. Those won't be listed here because they have yet to be approved, but they are in process now. process now and that includes another planning grant applications been submitted by George Mason University with a partnership with Frederick County and Shenandoah counties and then there is also an application from James Madison University who is applying for a planning grant as well for everyone going to work with their Workplace Readiness Academy with Rockingham County Public Schools we are currently and I do want to thank before I go any further our planning

[01:32:00] review committee which has rotated through and had seen all the applications you have in the spreadsheet in front of you and they're they're still working to do that and that's led by ms schultz here in the agency i do want to thank them publicly as we continue to to accept planning grant applications but for the record and for the public i will note that with our uh our deadline approaching here quickly at the end of june to obligate our funds we encourage anyone out there who still would like to apply for a planning grant to do so as soon as possible so that we can go ahead and work with you to work toward that submission of your full application. So currently

[01:32:36] we do have a balance now of approximately one and a half million dollars. So we have spent close to three and a half million dollars of the planning grant fund. We did extend, I will note, the planning grant deadlines. These were all granted for one year. We did find it would be beneficial for our applicants, many of whom are funding staff positions and still working on applications, to have some

additional time to utilize their funds. There was no provision of additional funding, but we did extend all of our planning grants that were awarded prior to August

[01:33:13] 1st of this year by four months. So they now have 16 months rather than 12 months to ensure that they have time to develop their application. And that has been met with appreciation for many of our applicants, many of whom we've seen in person recently in the last couple of weeks. Any questions about where we are currently with our planning grant fund? What is the final sort of drop dead for anybody to get their planning grant through the process, through here to the state board at this point, Dr. Armstrong? Thank you for asking, Dr. Moran. I sent a detailed communication out

[01:33:49] two weeks ago, Friday, that went to anyone who is either in our pipeline right now as a planning grant recipient or who I've spoken to who was considering applying. And what it comes down to is that we need to have our applications for lab school implementations, such as the one that we heard today from George Mason, submitted to the VDOE to our office for review no later than the beginning of February. And that allows for the runway for us to review the application in our agency, provide it to you all for first and second review, and then provide it to the state board

[01:34:26] before we provide the 90 days for contract ratification. So that being said, Dr. Moran, I think the timeline for the planning grant, and I put this in my communication, if you would like to apply for a planning grant, that's fine, but that deadline is going to have to drive everything. So if you apply for a planning grant, as we do have a few that are in process, tomorrow it doesn't change the fact that we still have to have your application submitted by the beginning of February.

[01:34:49] So that is really going to be up to the applicant to ensure that they meet those deadlines, but we are still taking them as we speak. First, I'd like to comment that we do want to thank the Ms. Schultz and the members of the committee that have been reviewing the planning grant applications for their time and expertise. This has been a tremendous amount of work, and they've really done an exceptional job, did so very swiftly, most of it done last year.

[01:35:17] without fanfare, and they do deserve our gratitude and appreciation. And I really also want to compliment Dr. Armstrong. We have had many conversations, and he is proactively reaching out to not only planning grant awardees, but educating them on the timeline that was just shared and discussed, and also the importance of providing an automatic extension to the planning grant awardees so that they can continue to work on their application. This was something that came

[01:35:53] up in one of our site visits. We heard from one of our potential lab school applicants that the deadline of November 1 for distribution of funds was going to create some real challenge for them to continue, frankly, just to remain on salary and complete their application. So again, And I want to just highlight that, you know, VDOE is really, I think throughout this process, we've really kind of had two guiding stars. The first has been the importance of public transparency that would produce a high quality process. The second is that we are good partners and really work alongside with their applicants, meeting them where they're at, quite literally in

[01:36:31] some cases, getting on the road and meeting them where they're at, but really being responsive and supporting them through this process. And the work that Dr. Armstrong is leading behind the scenes with the planning grant awardees to educate them about the timeline, the process to move through and to submit an application has really been a model for that shared collaboration and partnership with applicants. So thank you, Dr. Armstrong, for your work there. Thank you for your support. And I will say

that all dovetails because as I have these individual conversations with applicants as they're preparing their application, it's informing our work too as we look at making

[01:37:10] significant revisions down the road to our application as we provide guidance that you see today. One that I'll be speaking about in a minute for per-people funding, best practice for lottery. Those initiatives are sourced in these conversations that I've been having on a regular basis with applicants, potential applicants. Just last Friday, I spoke to another team, UVA, that was considering applying for a planning grant. We've been on site at JMU, mountain gateway mary washington emory and henry uh when during our time in abingdon i spent a few hours with the team out there and someone i'm forgetting but we've we've taken the taken the

[01:37:47] road tour it's been great for for everyone so we're excited about what we see coming through thank you dr armstrong for that update um at this point do you want to move to item either i would love to okay thank you item e is our pipeline presentation i took this and i i did revise it a bit to make it more clear for the public about where all our applicants are in the process and i'm gonna skip over to that if i can nope that's we're not there yet i'm gonna ask my tech team to

[01:38:23] give me a hand here i'm sorry i just jumped way ahead you'll see in your agenda thank you in the pipeline presentation i've taken this and made it a very easy to read table and i developed this a few weeks ago so yellow is good yellow means that we have we have accomplished that step so you can see that i've ordered this from those who have accomplished more yellow than to those who have not and this includes 19 of our lab school applicants which which i include from among that list of

[01:39:02] planning grant recipients that you saw in our previous presentation and you can also add that it is there great richard bland other applications was received recently did not apply for a planning grant but they are in the pipeline and their applications now with our videoe team to review james madison university as i mentioned did apply for planning grants so since i created this presentation that's changed too i've ordered this from left to right planning grant approved to contract execution i've also indicated the superintendent's regions from which each of our applicants comes i think that's important to note we have a very good geographic diversity in our

[01:39:39] applicants right now in our potential lab schools and i have had conversations with i'd say all except for maybe two of these institutions individually and have communicated with them either way via email to ensure that they're aware of our timeline so i wanted to provide that for you also you can see here this is suggested it's it's not set in stone but where we are right now We received our Richard Bland application this month.

[01:40:08] We anticipate receiving an application from UVA. They were saying November 8th, potentially, for their submission. And then today we reviewed GMU for Standing Committee 1, and then we approved UMW and Germana for 2. So you can see it cascade from there each month.

[01:40:23] We're hoping to receive applications from these institutions and more in the months ahead. That includes Emory & Henry, Eastern Shore Community College, two applications from ODU, James Madison, Mountain Gateway, Farron, Norfolk State, Lynchburg, Virginia Union, Piedmont, Virginia Community College, and Roanoke.

[01:40:40] And we did receive an application from Central Virginia Community College as well. We're currently reviewing that and providing them with feedback. So that is the cascading effect of our

application timeline right now. And we also added our interactive map.

[01:40:56] This is a screenshot. This is live, and I do have a link that I will share as we do our website revisions. But this gives you a quick snapshot of where all of our potential lab schools are located here in the state. And again, we'll keep this updated and suitable for public viewing as well on our website.

[01:41:15] Questions about our pipeline? Yes, ma'am. There is no applicant from Region 8 yet. It's the only one. Yes. That would be the South Side, Virginia. So that is the one region where we do not have any planning grant applicants.

[01:41:31] We had one and they withdrew. and that and that uh did not go all the way through have not had contact anyone else from any institutions in that part of the state as of late as you can see um we have a very busy several months ahead of us and so we're looking forward to the work um thank you again for the update of this chart the visuals are incredibly helpful and uh to note for the public these items will be continually updated not only on the website but they will be updated uh dr armstrong will be coming back each month and providing us with a verbal update as well at this time why don't

[01:42:10] we proceed with item f which is a memorandum on per pupil funding all right you'll see in your agenda the memorandum one per pupil funding and this was a question that had been brought up again in several applications and back in august of 2022 there was a presentation provided by the the Secretary of Education, I believe in front of this committee, I'm not mistaken, not the state board, but the idea was that we needed to create some reasonable limits on the asks of our college

[01:42:45] partnership lab school applicants. And thanks to the help of my colleagues in the Department of Finance and Budgeting, they were able to take the average per pupil share from a variety of sources in the direct aid formula and provide a per pupil number of 9,500 excuse me uh you all have 578 9 578 dollars and essentially what i'm informing applicants is that when you take your year-over-year enrollment and divide it into your ask your annual asset cannot exceed that number um that would be

[01:43:23] separate from your startup funds which you can ask for up to a million dollars but this this number two is based on FY24 budget calculations. So this can, again, fluctuate from fiscal year to fiscal year, but we do have that memorandum and we are providing that guidance to our applicants as well as they develop their budgets for their applications. So the memo explains that in much more detail, but I'm happy to take any questions this time. Any questions on this item? Again, this is in response to, thank you, gentlemen, this is in response to inquiries and comments that

[01:43:58] received from the lab school applicants that they were hoping for greater ease to understand this calculation and i'm glad we were able to deploy the expertise at videoe to do the to do the high math on this one because it's it's not an easy calculation to arrive at so thank you for the presentation of this item why don't we proceed then with item h certainly item h similar item that you're seeing that's a result of the conversations we've had with applicants lottery may sound like a real simple term but it's a little more complex than you may imagine especially

[01:44:34] when we are ensuring compliance with the law that we make our lab schools open any student in the commonwealth of virginia and in that spirit we were able to develop this best practice on administration for lotteries for college partnership lab schools and we are going to inform our applicants of this to again it it saves time too that's what it comes down to we We have applicants that will get mired in

some of the minutiae around compliance, and there are things that we can do to really make that more clear.

[01:45:05] And this is one of those areas I do want to thank Dr. Breezy, Janet Breezy, who's been one of our technical assistants, helps here with our applicants. And in her experience, another state was able to give us a very nice template to use that was reviewed by the OAG, and we will be providing this to our applicants.

[01:45:22] They again can propose a different way to administer a lottery, but we feel this is best practice and we'll communicate that to them. But as you can see in the memo, it outlines a lot of very practical and compliance steps on how to administer this process on behalf of their application.

[01:45:38] Any questions on this item? For the members of the committee, you will know that this particular item has been met with great smiles and gratitude from lab school applicants. They're like, oh, thank you. I mean, because this is everyone wants to do this well and do it right and do it within the compliance of the law as well as the spirit of the law.

[01:46:03] It reduces vulnerability. Exactly. Exactly. Reduces vulnerability and errors. All right. So at this time, we're going to talk about something, item I, which is the development of a college partnership lab school professional learning community. This is very exciting. Thank you, Madam Chair.

[01:46:20] Simultaneously, as we are approving applications and providing assistance to applicants as they submit their applications for lab schools, we really need to start to stand up a network for our newly opened lab schools that will be coming online as early as less than a year from now, as well as for those applicants.

[01:46:40] And this is going to promote the sustainability of the lab school initiative well past the five years that this grant will provide for. I was thinking about it when Dr. Sereda was giving a presentation. I hope in 100 years, someone's doing a slide presentation about the beginning of the Germana Future Educators Academy that was provided by this committee back in 2023, and it's still flourishing.

[01:47:05] But to do that, we need to be purposeful about how we really provide the opportunity to network for our lab schools and for our applicants. And you all heard from IALS, which Dr. Serata is a part of, as Ms. Wadisca mentioned, about those five tenets of lab schools and to really ground our work to provide support and resources to our applicants in our new lab schools around teacher prep research, curriculum development, innovation, and professional growth.

[01:47:32] And you're seeing that in the applications. It's heartening for me when I hear from Dr. Serata, who's in an established lab school, and from other folks we're going to hear from in the months ahead. and we see the same things happening in the applications that we're reviewing that means we're doing this the right way but but to continue that we want to make sure that we're providing our lab schools support they need to be sustainable well past the five years that we have so let's focus on those higher ed k-12 division partnerships and on the enhancement of teaching learning and leadership uh staff development opportunities curriculum view and recruitment are things that

[01:48:09] any school, any public school, any independent school, is going to have to wrestle with, and they're going to have to adapt and evolve as their school grows and as time moves on and demands change. So how can we really proactively do what we can to structure that network for them? Let's refine expectations around innovation and outcomes. Let's make sure that evidence-based practice is at the

forefront in instructional leadership in our lab schools, and let's leverage the scale to really advocate for that support of our program and the expansion of it. But that mentoring and partnership to our applicants is going to be crucial. And this is not a one and done initiative.

[01:48:49] And we want to start looking forward and start to develop that network sooner rather than later for our applicants. So go ahead. Yeah, Dr. Armstrong, thank you. For members of the committee, this is something that each of us, each of you have spoken to me about privately, as well as we've discussed here in the committee, the importance of creating a network. And so Dr.

[01:49:13] Armstrong is going to walk through some next steps. We've heard from you that you really want a plan, really want to see how the lab schools will be supported, how they will have a professional community that is created. And so this is the reflection of much internal work as to how that might be executed by video please continue mr and we we also are working to leverage resources that that are at our disposal as well um you know our work here in the agency our bandwidth is limited but there are also uh organizations and individuals in the commonwealth who who can really help us

[01:49:52] take this to the next step we're exploring every option for that but but to do this in practical terms. We'll need to set minimum membership requirements for the group. You know, how many approved and operational lab schools in a timeline for that implementation? What will the leadership be? Will that be sourced here in the agency? Will we consider someone who's outside of the agency who could possibly lead that with some detailed experience with lab schools? Have some type of kickoff or summit to identify their priorities and logistics of that group? Mission, vision, strategic goals, just boilerplate 101 for any organization. Communications and a marketing plan,

[01:50:27] which includes your website, social media, and just idea-sharing platforms for our lab schools. And then what are the outcomes? How can we develop some statistics and data to really inform the needs and priorities of that network and continue to leverage those national and international opportunities for learning?

[01:50:45] You know, all of our lab schools to hear from someone like we did this morning from the Fox School or from Dr. Ramos from ILS, we'll be hearing from other lab schools in the months ahead, And keeping those networks engaged is going to be critical, as we all know, to have these empathetic colleagues in any endeavor you're taking is going to be valuable, and we know it will be for our lab schools as well.

[01:51:10] So, again, this is very conceptual right now, I know, but I want to make it clear to the committee that this is not something we're simply putting on the back burner. We know that the mission critical work right now is getting our applications moving and getting them in front of you and in front of our state board. but we know we can't neglect this.

[01:51:27] We want to make this a sustainable initiative. So just laying out some steps for you all and having to answer any questions or take any suggestions. I hope what comes through in Dr. Armstrong's presentation of this item is also that we're really trying to proactively think about the professional learning community and the support for lab schools prior to us having a number of them as well.

[01:51:54] You know, there's roughly 200 lab schools in the world. at the end of this process we'll see how many we have here in virginia but we'll have at this juncture potentially you know several and we would certainly want to make sure that they have support for each other for the continuance of that work and the support to learn and apply what is learned and to share that broadly across the commonwealth i think

that's how we've all discussed we'll have the greatest benefit from the investment that's being made here is when we all benefit from the information and knowledge that's gained through that, such as was discussed this morning,

[01:52:33] developing the innovative curriculum. What works? What's effective? What's a differentiator? Sharing out those lessons. We know that Virginia has a long history of innovation in public schools, and this would be a way to capture and share and elevate that information.

[01:52:50] Any other questions or comments from members of the committee? Okay. Hearing none, and i think that concludes the dr armstrong show for now thank you excellent all right and um are there any for discussion of current issues i have one item i'm just going to bring up briefly but are there anything from members of the committee first no okay um i will be engaging uh the members of the committee as well as staff to further explore the possibility of virtual meetings

[01:53:25] and i wanted to surface that for the benefit of the public there's been some consideration of we've heard from our applicants that you can see the work ahead of us that we're going to have a number uh we're going to very busy months in december january february march and in talking with our applicants and understanding just how big and vast virginia is you know i think sometimes it's not well known a fun fact we always like to say is when you go to the west of virginia you've hit all the way to detroit we have a very large state and so one of the things that we're going

[01:54:03] to be exploring with staff is the possibility of having virtual meetings to help support our applicants as well as to ensure certainly public transparency and engagement but to ensure that there is ease as we go into these winter months and we are on the time frame that we are and we We want to make sure that there are not delays such as weather that might impede the consideration of an applicant.

[01:54:29] There are some considerations that the committee would have to take under advisement such, for example, there are only so many virtual meetings that could be held per year or a certain percentage. They have to be posted and noticed just like all other meetings that would have to be a planned endeavor.

[01:54:47] But this is something that we're going to work with staff and each of the committee members to explore. And if appropriate, we would take public comment on in December to see if the public has a strong feeling one way or the other. We certainly want to take that into consideration. But we do want to explore this, again, proactively in advance of the Virginia version of the winter season. I am cognizant of having just driven out to Mountain Gateway, that coming down off the mountain in January with ice can be a little tricky. Yeah. Or even coming out of Charlottesville.

[01:55:24] And so we'll want to make sure that we can conduct our business and do so expeditiously. So I just want to kind of put that out there for the benefit of the public. We will have further discussion about it in December and we will take public comment on it in December, but that is just something that we're working on. Yeah. Any comments from the committee members on that at this time?

[01:55:44] And I don't necessarily need some because I know I'm just putting you on the spot here, i just wanted to surface this item i think it's a good idea and just um appreciate you and the staffs uh travel time commitment that goes into this each of these applications are a lot of work on the institutional side of things and so just um appreciate the thoughtfulness of trying to figure out how we continue to do the work that we need to do and come up with the best outcomes so thank

[01:56:21] Thank you Madam Chair. Thank you. Yeah, I'll just second that, Madam Chair. I think obviously the work that the team puts at the Department is great. The work that members put in, particularly folks like yourself, Ms. Moran, Mr. Bailey, and so to the extent we can have, be as inclusive as possible. Your point on geography is extremely important. It is a very big Commonwealth, so be as inclusive as possible, as efficient as possible.

[01:56:53] I'm up for anything that we can do to add that flexibility, and I think with the technology and again with the great work that the team here does, the work that Andy's leading, we can do that in a way that it is high quality and effective, but maybe it will be both more efficient and more inclusive.

[01:57:10] All right. Hearing no further discussion at this time, is there any public comment on non-agenda items, Mr. Chapman or Dr. Armstrong? No. Okay. Thank you, Mr. Chapman.

[01:57:27] all right sorry no further business before the committee we stand adjourned thank you again for your deliberation thank you